

Business English

Every workbook exercise and self-check answered, with model answers, notes on acceptable alternatives and the common learner errors to expect. Confidential teacher material.

4 modules

Exercise, model & quiz answers

Confidential – do not distribute

CONTENTS

MOD 1 Professional Communication Foundations

- 1.1 Business Register, Tone & First Impressions
- 1.2 Professional Emails & Messaging
- 1.3 Telephoning & Virtual Calls

MOD 2 Meetings & Interpersonal Skills

- 2.1 Meetings — Participating & Chairing
- 2.2 Small Talk, Networking & Building Rapport
- 2.3 Diplomatic & Assertive Communication

MOD 3 Presenting, Negotiating & Persuading

- 3.1 Presentations — Structure & Delivery
- 3.2 Negotiations — Language & Strategy
- 3.3 Pitching, Persuasion & Handling Objections

MOD 4 Business Writing & Career

- 4.1 Reports, Proposals & Business Documents
- 4.2 CVs, Cover Letters & Job Interviews
- 4.3 Review Project — The Complete Business Communicator

Module 1 — Professional Communication Foundations: Answers

Answers to every Module 1 workbook exercise and self-check question, with the "why," acceptable alternatives, model versions for the open tasks (the elevator pitch, the rewrites, the formal request and the four supplier replies, the phone-call message pads), notes on the C1 welcome pages, and the errors you can expect to meet most. The diagnostic tasks, the course rubric and the diagnostic model answers are in

[assessment/needs-analysis.html](#) and [assessment/assessment-key.html](#).

Lessons 1.1–1.3 + C1

Classes C1–C4

12 self-check items

16 exercises

MARKING PRINCIPLE

This is a communication course, so mark **closed** items (matching, ordering, sorting, dictation) as right or wrong, and **open** items (rewrites, subject lines, emails, pitches) against purpose and register. For open items, the models below are *examples*. Accept any version that (1) keeps the full message (the ask, the deadline, the numbers), (2) is in a register that suits the reader, (3) is polite **and** clear (one softener, not five), and (4) is accurate enough not to confuse. When a learner's version is correct but misses the lesson target, accept it and point to the target: "Good. Can you also frame it positively?" American English is the model; **accept British spellings and conventions** (*Ms Alvarez, apologise, Yours faithfully, 12 September*) whenever a learner uses them consistently. Use the four rubric criteria by name when you give feedback: **Task & Purpose, Register & Tone, Language Range & Accuracy, Organization & Delivery**.

C1 · WELCOME PAGES (ORIENTATION)

◆ HOW WE WORK TOGETHER, MY GOALS, PROGRESS TRACKER

No answers: these belong to the learner. Check only that (1) each goal names a **situation** and something the learner wants to be **able to do**, with a time ("by C8") — "improve my English" is not yet a goal; help them narrow it ("Which situation? Emails to clients? Then: by C8, write a request email to a new client in ten minutes"), (2) goals are realistic for eight weeks, and (3) the progress tracker is filled in privately after you return the diagnostic notes in C3. Learners between jobs may write goals about interviews or networking: that's exactly right.

◆ WARM-UP — THREE WAYS TO ASK

Most → least formal: **B** (1) → **C** (2) → **A** (3). Client: **B** (a first or formal contact) · Manager: **C** (neutral; B for a sensitive request or a very formal workplace) · Close colleague: **A** (or C). All three are acceptable at work; the choice depends on the reader and the relationship. "*When you get a sec*" is friendly-professional; avoid it with clients and senior people you don't know well.

1.1 · BUSINESS REGISTER, TONE & FIRST IMPRESSIONS (C2)

◆ EXERCISE 1 — RANK THE REGISTER

Set	1 (most formal)	2	3 (least formal)
1	b) Would it be possible to arrange...	a) Can we meet tomorrow?	c) Free tomorrow for a quick chat?
2	b) ...your assistance in this matter.	a) Thanks for your help with this.	c) Thanks a million!
3	c) Unfortunately, I will be unable to attend...	a) I'm afraid I won't be able to attend.	b) Can't make it, sorry!

Clues to point out: *would / it be possible · assistance · in this matter · unable · will be* (full forms) = formal; contractions and dropped subjects ("Can't make it," "Free tomorrow?") = informal. "Can't make it, sorry!" is fine in a chat with a close colleague, not in a reply to a client.

◆ EXERCISE 2 – FORMAL, NEUTRAL OR FRIENDLY?

1 F · 2 FP · 3 F · 4 N · 5 FP · 6 F · 7 N · 8 FP. Accept N for 4 or 7 only; if a learner argues 5 is N, accept it if they explain ("in my team, 'just a quick one' is normal"); the point is that register is a spectrum. "Please do not hesitate to contact me" is formal and a little old-fashioned in email; "Let me know if you have any questions" is the everyday version.

◆ EXERCISE 3 – SOFTEN THE TONE (MODELS)

- 1 Could you give me a quick update when you have a moment?
- 2 I'm not sure that approach would work here. Could we look at another option? (*also: I see it a little differently...*)
- 3 Would it be possible to have this by 3? It would really help me meet the deadline.
- 4 Would it be possible to arrange a meeting with your manager? (*also: I'd like to set up a meeting with your manager, if possible.*)
- 5 I'm afraid we can't deliver on Friday, but we can deliver first thing on Monday. (*positive framing: lead with or add what you can do*)

Accept any version with one clear softener and the full message (the deadline "by 3" must stay). **Don't accept** over-softened versions ("Could you maybe possibly perhaps...") or ones that lose the request ("An update would be nice someday"). Number 2 must still disagree: diplomacy changes the tone, not the message.

◆ EXERCISE 4 – TWO FIRST MEETINGS (SCRIPT 1.1-A)

- 1 Meeting 2.
- 2 Any two: he answers "Yeah. Rafael." (no full name, no company, no "pleasure to meet you") · he describes his job vaguely ("that kind of stuff") · he asks for coffee and the meeting room before any courtesy · he just says "Hi" to Dev · he asks "how long will this take?" (sounds impatient) · he asks no questions and doesn't use names.
- 3 He's the **account manager** for Brightline Foods: he looks after all their deliveries from Northwind's side.
- 4 "Can I introduce you to my colleague?"
- 5 He **leads the warehouse team**.
- 6 "Thanks, Karen. And please call me Rafael."

Phrases heard in Meeting 2: ✓ It's a pleasure to meet you · ✓ Likewise · ✗ How do you do? · ✓ Thanks for making the time · ✓ I've heard great things about... · ✗ Have you two met?

◆ EXERCISE 5 – RESPOND NATURALLY

1 d · 2 a · 3 e · 4 b · 5 f · 6 c. "How do you do?" is a formal greeting, not a question: the answer is the same words. Accept "Likewise" for 1 as well.

◆ DIALOGUE – MOVING TO FIRST NAMES

First names: Lena: "Please, call me Lena." → Sam: "Then please call me Sam." (Sam used "Ms. Ortiz" until invited.)
Introduction: "Have you met my colleague? This is Mei Lin, **who** looks after our events." Softened request: "Would it be possible to go through them after the meeting?" Also point out "It's great to finally meet you in person" (a warm opener after phone or email contact) and Lena's role line: "I'm responsible for the design of..."

◆ MY ELEVATOR PITCH AND THE WELCOME RECEPTION (MODELS)

Model (role card 2, Amira Haddad): "Hi, I'm Amira Haddad. I'm an accounts assistant at Harbor Point Supplies, where I make sure our suppliers are paid correctly and on time. I'm a qualified accountant, and I'm currently completing my local certification. I understand your team is moving to a new invoicing system. I'd love to hear how it's going." **Check:** all four parts (name, role, what I do / value, hook); 3–4 sentences; no life story; a hook that invites a reply. The reception has no answers: use the observer checklist and the four rubric criteria. Good exit lines to praise: "It was great to meet you. I'll let you get back to the others." · "Let's continue this over coffee after the meeting."

◆ SELF-CHECK

Q1

First email to a client. Which opening fits best?

A) Hey! Quick one for you...

B) Need to talk about the contract.

C) Dear Ms. Alvarez, I would like to introduce myself...

Why: a first external contact calls for a formal, respectful register. A is too casual; B has no greeting and sounds abrupt.

Q2

Which response best softens a refusal while staying professional?

A) No, I can't.

B) I'm afraid I can't make Tuesday, but I'm free Thursday if that helps.

C) Um, maybe I possibly might not be able to...

Why: it declines clearly and offers an alternative (positive framing). A is blunt; C is over-softened and sounds unsure.

Q3 · new

Which is the best neutral request to a colleague?

A) Could you send me the figures when you have a moment?

B) Send me the figures.

C) I would be most grateful if you could possibly perhaps send the figures, if it is not too much trouble.

Why: one modal question + one hedge = polite and clear. B sounds like an order; C is over-formal and over-softened for a colleague.

Q4 · new

A senior visitor says, "How do you do?" What do you answer?

A) I'm fine, thank you.

B) How do you do?

C) Not bad, and you?

Why: "How do you do?" is a very formal greeting, not a real question, so you repeat it. A and C answer a question that wasn't asked; C is also too casual for a senior visitor.

ERRORS YOU WILL MEET MOST (1.1)

"I want you send me..." / "Give me..." (direct translation) · flat intonation on correct words · "I am agree" · "I am engineer" (missing article) · "I work here since 2019" (→ *I've worked*) · "Nice to see you" at a first meeting (→ *Nice to meet you*; see is for people you already know) · "I'm fine" in reply to "How do you do?" · "Mr. David" (title + first name) · stacked softeners ("Could you maybe possibly...") · over-formal set phrases ("It is an honor to make your acquaintance"). For range, praise *Thanks for making the time* · *I've heard great things about...* · *I'm responsible for...* · *Would it be possible to...?* · *I'm afraid..., but...*

1.2 · PROFESSIONAL EMAILS & MESSAGING (C3)

◆ MODEL EMAIL – QUESTIONS

1. Parts: **1** Subject: Training room booking... · **2** Dear Ms. Grant, · **3** Thank you for sending your conference brochure last week. · **4** We would like to book... I would be grateful if you could... by Friday, March 6. (+ the attachment line "Please find attached...", which is part of the body) · **5** Please let me know if you need any further details. I look forward to hearing from you. · **6** Sincerely, · **7** Sofia Brandt, Office Manager, Kestrel Design. 2. Purpose: to book the Harbor Room / confirm availability and the full price for the March 18 training day. 3. Ask: "I would be grateful if you could confirm availability and the full price..."; deadline: **Friday, March 6**. 4. Yes, formal throughout: *Dear Ms. Grant ... Sincerely · I would be grateful · We would like (full forms) · Please find attached · further details.*

◆ EXERCISE 1 – PUT THE EMAIL IN ORDER

c → b → e → d → f → a (subject → greeting → opening line → body / clear ask → closing line → sign-off + name). "Dear Mr. Patel ... Best regards" is a normal, polite pairing in modern business email: neutral-formal and consistent. (*Sincerely* would be slightly more formal.)

◆ EXERCISE 2 – MATCH THE PHRASE TO ITS FUNCTION

1 **opening** · 2 **attachment** · 3 **request** · 4 **follow-up** · 5 **bad news** · 6 **closing** · 7 **follow-up** · 8 **request**. Accept "request" for 4 or 7 if the learner explains that a follow-up also asks for something: they overlap. "Regrettably" is formal; "Unfortunately" is the everyday version.

◆ EXERCISE 3 – FIX THE SUBJECT LINE (MODELS)

- 1 Slides for Friday's review: your comments by Wed? (*also: Please review my slides by Wednesday*)
- 2 Question about invoice #3390 (*also: Quick question re: invoice #3390*)
- 3 Action needed: approve weekend overtime by 4 p.m. today
- 4 Move Thursday team meeting to Fri 10 a.m.? (*also: Team meeting: new time Friday 10 a.m.*)
- 5 FYI: warehouse closed Monday (inspection)

Accept any subject line that names the topic **and** signals the action or deadline (or "FYI" when no action is needed). Short is good: 4–9 words. Don't accept "URGENT" on 5: nothing is required, so it isn't urgent.

◆ EXERCISE 4 – REWRITE THE BLUNT EMAIL (MODEL)

Subject: Sales figures + a quick slide fix, today if possible

Hi Marco,

Could you send me the latest sales figures when you get a moment? I'd need them by the end of the day for tomorrow's review, if that's doable.

One more thing: I think a couple of numbers on the slides need updating. I'm happy to point them out on a quick call.

Thanks so much,

Ana

What changed: a specific subject; a greeting; a softened request with a deadline; the criticism reframed diplomatically ("need updating," not "are wrong") with an offer of help; a warm sign-off. Friendly-professional or neutral are both fine here (an internal colleague). Strong learners may split it into two emails (one purpose each) or number the two asks: both acceptable.

◆ EXERCISE 5 – CHAT OR EMAIL? REPLY OR REPLY ALL?

1 **chat** (quick, informal, right now) · 2 **email** (external, formal, needs a record) · 3 **CC** · 4 **Reply** (only the sender needs your thanks) · 5 **BCC** (protects people's addresses) · 6 **Reply All** (everyone genuinely needs it). For 5, some organizations use a mailing tool instead; BCC is the answer for ordinary email.

◆ EXERCISE 6 – THE MANAGER'S VOICEMAIL (SCRIPT 1.2-A)

Write to	Mr. Daniel Okoro (O-K-O-R-O), Harbor Point Supplies
What we need	an updated quote ; the price must include delivery
Quantity and item	40 standing desks, model KD-20

Deadline (and why)	by Friday the 14th , because the budget meeting is the following Monday
What to attach	our original specification
Register	formal : it's the first time working with them

Traps: *forty* (desks) vs *fourteenth* (the date): check learners didn't write "14 desks" or "Friday the 40th"; "not the KD-12" (Lena mentions an old model).

◆ THE FORMAL REQUEST (MODEL)

Subject: Request for updated quote: 40 KD-20 standing desks, by Friday the 14th

Dear Mr. Okoro,

I am writing on behalf of Kestrel Design to request an updated quote for 40 standing desks, model KD-20.

I would be grateful if you could include delivery in the price and send us the quote by Friday the 14th, as our budget meeting takes place the following Monday.

Please find attached our original specification for your reference.

Please let me know if you need any further information. I look forward to hearing from you.

Sincerely,

Kenji Mori

Graphic Designer, Kestrel Design

The voicemail doesn't name the learner's company: they use their real company (optional), a role card or an invented one.

Check: all six facts; a specific subject with the deadline; a formal frame (*Dear Mr. Okoro ... Sincerely / Yours sincerely / Kind regards*); one purpose; the ask near the top. Accept "Thank you in advance for your help" as the closing. Don't accept "Dear Daniel" (too familiar for a first contact) or "Hi Mr. Okoro" (mixed register).

◆ REPLY IN ROLE (MODELS FOR THE FOUR SUPPLIER REPLY CARDS)

- 1 Yes, on time.** "Dear Mr./Ms. ____, Thank you for your email. Please find attached our updated quote for 40 KD-20 standing desks at \$389 per desk, including delivery (total \$15,560). The quote is valid for 30 days. Please let me know if you have any questions. Sincerely, Daniel Okoro"
- 2 Yes, but one detail is missing.** "...Thank you for your request. Before I can send the final quote, could you please confirm the delivery address and the color you would like (black or white)? I will then send the quote within one working day. Kind regards, Daniel Okoro"
- 3 A delay, with an alternative.** "...Unfortunately, the KD-20 is out of stock until next month. We can deliver it in five weeks, or we can offer the KD-24, a very similar model, at \$405 per desk including delivery, available now. Please let me know which option you prefer, and I will send the quote by Friday. Sincerely, Daniel Okoro"
- 4 A question before quoting.** "...Thank you for your email. Could you let me know whether you would like the desks assembled on site? Assembly costs an additional \$25 per desk. As soon as I hear from you, I will send the full quote, within 24 hours. Kind regards, Daniel Okoro"

$\$389 \times 40 = \$15,560$. Look for: the reply answers the request; bad news uses *Unfortunately / I'm afraid* and positive framing (card 3); questions are softened (cards 2 and 4); the frame stays formal.

Q1

Which subject line best follows the "specific and useful" rule?

A) Budget approval needed by Thu 5 p.m.

B) Important!!

C) Budget

Why: it says the topic and the action and deadline, so the reader knows exactly what to do. B and C tell the reader almost nothing.

Q2

"Dear Sir or Madam," (British style). Which sign-off matches?

A) Yours faithfully,

B) Yours sincerely,

C) Cheers,

Why: an unnamed reader pairs with "Yours faithfully" (never two S's together: Sir → faithfully). A named reader pairs with "Yours sincerely." In American style, "Sincerely," is used for both, so accept a learner who explains that. C is far too casual.

Q3 • new

An email about a room change went to 30 people. You want to thank the sender.

A) Reply All.

B) Forward it to your team with "Thanks!"

C) Reply only to the sender.

Why: the Reply-All test: does every person need to read this? No, only the sender. A fills 29 inboxes; B sends it to people who didn't need it.

Which closing line is correct?

A) I look forward to hear from you.

B) I look forward to hearing from you.

C) I am looking forward for your reply.

Why: in *look forward to*, *to* is a preposition, so it takes a noun or **-ing**: *to hearing / to your reply*. C has the wrong preposition (*for*).

ERRORS YOU WILL MEET MOST (1.2)

Vague or blank subject lines · the ask in the last paragraph, or no deadline · mismatched frame ("Dear Mr. Okoro ... Cheers," "Hi Mr. Okoro") · "Dear Mr. Daniel" (title + first name) · archaic or regional formulas ("Kindly do the needful," "Please revert," "Thanks and regards") · "I'm writing *for* ask" · "look forward to hear" · "discuss about" · "informations / advices / equipments" · "Please find attach" · "I send you the file" (→ *I've attached / I'm sending*) · "until Friday" for a deadline (→ *by Friday*) · several purposes in one email. For range, praise *I would be grateful if you could...* · *Further to our conversation* · *As a gentle reminder* · *Please find attached... for your reference* · *Unfortunately..., but we can...*

1.3 · TELEPHONING & VIRTUAL CALLS (C4)

◆ EXERCISE 1 – MATCH THE PHRASE TO THE STAGE

a 3 (connect / hold) · b 4 (unavailable) · c 1 (answer / identify) · d 2 (purpose) · e 5 (message) · f 6 (end) · g 3 · h 2. "Is this a good time to talk?" belongs to the caller's opening; it's a courtesy before stating the purpose. Accept 1 for h if the learner explains it as part of the opening.

◆ EXERCISE 2 – PUT THE CALL IN ORDER

b → d → f → h → a → e → g → c. Priya answers and identifies (b); Rafael gives his name, company and who he wants (d); Priya signposts the hold and offers a message (f); Rafael gives the reason for the callback (h); Priya asks for his details (a); Rafael spells his name and gives the number (e); Priya reads it back (g); Rafael closes (c).

◆ DICTATION – NAMES, NUMBERS, DATES (SCRIPT 1.3-C)

- 1 Tomasz Nowak
- 2 (206) 555-0172
- 3 7700-B
- 4 15 boxes by the 14th
- 5 s.brandt@kestreldesign.com
- 6 Thursday, April 3, at 2:30 (Eastern)

Accept any clear format for numbers (206-555-0172; 3 April; 2:30 p.m.). Common errors: 50 for 15, 40th for 14th, 770B (a missed "double oh"), *Brand* for Brandt, a missing dot in the email. Accept "Tomas" only if the learner asks you to spell it: that's the

point.

◆ EXERCISE 3 – TAKE THE MESSAGE (SCRIPT 1.3-B)

For	Marcus Lee
Time of call	any time the learner writes (the habit is what matters)
Caller	Joanna Wexford (W-E-X-F-O-R-D)
Company · phone	Kestrel Design · (617) 555-0183
About	the new brochure proofs : they're ready; Marcus must approve them before printing
Key details	print date moved from Wednesday the 14th to Tuesday the 13th · the printer can make 15 sample copies (not 50) before then
Callback	please call her back before 3 p.m. on Thursday

Traps: the old date (the 14th), "fifty" (what Marcus asked for), "until four" (when Marcus's meeting ends, not the callback time).

◆ EXERCISE 4 – FIX THE MESSAGE (MODEL)

(a) Missing: **who** called (name), **which company**, their **number**, **which order / what it's about**, **when** they called and **by when** they need a callback. (b) Model: "Sam Bexley, from Harbor Point Supplies, called at 10:15 about order #4471 (the delivery is two boxes short). Please call back at (415) 555-0126 before 5 p.m. today." (c) Saying it: "Bexley: B as in Bravo, E as in Echo, X as in X-ray, L as in Lima, E as in Echo, Y as in Yankee. Four-one-five, five-five-five, oh-one-two-six." Then: "So that's Bexley, B-E-X-L-E-Y, at (415) 555-0126. Is that right?" Any clear spelling words are fine.

◆ EXERCISE 5 – VIDEO-CALL TROUBLE

1 c · 2 a · 3 e · 4 f · 5 b · 6 d. Accept "Can you hear me?" type answers as extra language for 1, and "Could you drop it in the chat?" as a helpful follow-up for 3.

◆ DIALOGUE – OPENING A VIDEO MEETING

Audio check: "Can everyone hear me OK?" · Mute: "Priya, I think you're on mute." · Screen share: "I'll share my screen so we're all looking at the same agenda." · Ground rule: "Let's use the chat for any questions as we go" (also "I'll pause after each item") · Handover by name: "Tom, over to you for item one."

◆ BACK-TO-BACK PHONE CALLS – MESSAGE PADS (MATERIALS, SET F)

Call	For	From / company	Phone	About	Callback / next step
1	Tomasz Nowak (back at 3 p.m.)	Kim Tran (T-R-A-N), Brightline Foods	(312) 555-0164	order #5216 (12 pallets of packaging) was due yesterday and hasn't arrived; needs a new delivery date	call back today before 5 p.m.
2	Lena Ortiz (on another	Sam Okafor (O-K-A-F-O-R),	(206) 555-	wants to move Tuesday's 10 a.m.	please confirm by email : s.okafor@crestviewhotels.com (or

	call)	Crestview Hotels	0139	brochure meeting to Thursday at 2:30 p.m.	call back)
3 (stretch)	Ana Ruiz, accounts (away until Monday)	Priya Nair (N- A-I-R), Harbor Point Supplies	(617) 555- 0118	invoice #4821: Brightline paid \$1,450 , but the invoice total is \$1,540 (a difference of \$90)	no one else can help → Ana to call back Monday morning

The caller checks the pad against their card. Any wrong detail = practice the read-back again. In Call 3, praise a receiver who confirms both amounts ("So that's one thousand four hundred fifty paid, one thousand five hundred forty on the invoice?") and handles the unavailable colleague with positive framing ("She's away until Monday, but I'll make sure she calls you first thing").

◆ SELF - CHECK

Q1

A caller asks for a colleague who is in a meeting. Which response fits best?

A) One moment, I'll put you through.

B) He's not here. Call back later.

C) I'm afraid he's in a meeting right now. Can I take a message?

Why: it explains the absence politely and offers a next step. A connects to someone who isn't available; B is blunt and gives the caller nothing.

Q2

You didn't quite catch a client's phone number.

A) Write down your best guess and move on.

B) "Sorry, could you repeat the last three digits? Let me read it back to check."

C) Say nothing and hope it arrives in an email.

Why: ask specifically, then read it back. Guessing (A) or hoping (C) risks a wrong callback, which costs far more than five seconds of checking.

Q3 · new

What is the best way to start a call that you make?

A) This is Ana from Northwind Logistics.

B) I am Ana. Who are you?

C) Hello, here is Ana speaking from Northwind.

Why: on the phone, English uses *This is...* + name + company. B is a direct translation and "Who are you?" sounds rude (→ *Who's calling, please?* is for the receiver). C mixes *here is* (a translation) with *speaking*, which is for answering.

Q4 · new

On a video call, a colleague's audio keeps cutting out.

A) Nothing. Pretend you heard and continue.

B) "Your internet is terrible."

C) "Sorry, you're breaking up a little. Could you repeat that last part?"

Why: name the problem neutrally ("breaking up a little") and ask for a repeat. A risks a misunderstanding; B blames the person and sounds rude.

ERRORS YOU WILL MEET MOST (1.3)

"I am Ana / Here is Ana" (→ *This is Ana / Ana speaking*) · "Who are you? / Who is speaking?" (→ *Who's calling, please?*) · answering with only "Hello?" · a silent hold · no read-back · fifteen / fifty and fourteen / forty confusion · "call me back to this number" (→ *at / on*) · letter names A / E / I and G / J confused when spelling · "Speak slowly!" (→ *Would you mind speaking a little more slowly?*) · "Would you mind to spell" (→ *spelling*) · 03/04-style dates read the local way. For range, praise *Bear with me a moment* · *I'm afraid...*, *can I take a message?* · *Let me read that back to you* · *B as in Bravo* · *Sorry, you go ahead* · *Over to you, Priya*.

Module 2 — Meetings & Interpersonal Skills: Answers

Answers to every Module 2 workbook exercise and self-check question, with model answers for the rewriting and writing tasks, acceptable alternatives, and the errors you can expect to meet most. The Midpoint Performance Check rubric, model answers, role cards and scoring sheets are in [assessment/assessment-key.html](https://www.oup.com/uk/ebooks/9780190110000/assessment/assessment-key.html).

Lessons 2.1–2.3 + Midpoint Check

Classes C5–C8

12 self-check items

15 exercises

MARKING PRINCIPLE

Most Module 2 exercises test **function, register and tone**, so there is usually more than one good answer. Accept any answer that (1) does the job (disagrees, refuses, gives feedback...), (2) is appropriate in register for the reader or listener, (3) keeps the real message (firm on substance), and (4) is grammatically accurate enough to be clear. The models below show one good version; the "Also accept" notes list common alternatives. Reject answers that are only polite on the surface but lose the message ("Maybe, if it's OK, perhaps we could possibly..."), and answers that are clear but blunt. British spellings (*summarise*, *organise*, *practise*) and British phrases (*send the minutes round*) are fine. When you correct, praise the function first ("Good: you acknowledged first"), then fix the language.

2.1 • MEETINGS — PARTICIPATING & CHAIRING (C5)

◆ EXERCISE 1 – THE WEEKLY SYNC (SCRIPT 2.1-A)

a) To check the Northwind website launch is on track (for the 12th). b) They keep the 12th, but only if the client's photos arrive by Wednesday.

Who	What	By when
Tom	call the client about the photos (ask for a firm deadline)	tomorrow
Marco	finish the last two pages	Thursday
Priya	circulate / send around the updated budget	Friday

c) Heard: 1, 2, 4, 5, 6, 8. Not heard: 3 (*Could I offer a different view?*) and 7 (*Let me just finish my point*). **Expect:** learners writing "Wednesday" for Tom (Wednesday is the photo deadline, not Tom's), or "budget" without the verb (an action point needs a verb: *circulate*).

◆ EXERCISE 2 – WHAT DOES EACH PHRASE DO?

1	T (interrupt)	5	Cl	9	Cl (check understanding)
2	D	6	A	10	Ch (manage participation)
3	O	7	T (hold the floor)	11	D

4	Ch (follow the agenda)	8	O	12	A
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Discuss: 11 starts like agreement ("I take your point") but it is a polite **disagreement**: the acknowledgement is the softener. 10 could also be used by a participant, but it is typical chair language. **Expect:** 7 labeled as an interruption (it is the opposite: the speaker is protecting their turn).

◆ EXERCISE 3 – SUGGESTIONS AND COMMON MISTAKES

- 1 ask
- 2 using
- 3 move (*I'd suggest that we moved* = wrong)
- 4 take
- 5 share **or** shared (both correct; *shared* sounds a little more tentative)
- 6 postponing (also accept: *I suggest that we postpone*; not *to postpone*)
- 7 We need to discuss the budget. (or: We need to talk about the budget.)
- 8 I agree with Tom.
- 9 Can we have / hold a meeting on Friday? (also: Can we meet on Friday?)

◆ EXERCISE 4 – PUT THE CHAIR'S LINES IN ORDER

1 b · 2 d · 3 f · 4 h · 5 e · 6 c · 7 a · 8 g. Open (welcome → purpose) → first item → bring someone in → decide → next item → recap action points → thank and close. Accept d and b reversed only if the learner can explain it (some chairs state the purpose first), but the welcome usually comes first. h must come after f and before the decision in e.

◆ EXERCISE 5 – MAKE IT POLITE (MODELS)

- 1 "Sorry to interrupt, but can I just come in here?" / "If I could just add something..."
- 2 "I see your point, but I'm not sure I agree. Could we look at it again?"
- 3 "Sorry, could you expand on that?" / "Could you clarify what you mean by...?"
- 4 "I take your point, though have we considered a different approach? What if we...?"
- 5 "Let's give everyone a chance to speak. Sara, what do you think?" / "Thanks, Marco. Let's hear from Tom on this."

Test for every answer: did it acknowledge or signal first, and does it still do the job? For 5, the chair should never comment on the person ("you're talking too much"); they manage the **process** (invite others in by name). **Expect:** "*Excuse me, I want to say something*" (better, but *want* is still direct: suggest *Could I just...*) and over-softened answers for 2 ("Sorry, sorry, maybe I'm wrong, but perhaps...").

◆ MEETING PLANNER – WHAT A GOOD RESULT LOOKS LIKE

An agenda with three items (the third is usually AOB) and realistic times; a meeting that follows it; and **at least two action points in the who / what / when format**, each with a verb and a deadline ("Ana will book the venue by May 30"). For the Set B scenarios, possible compromises: 1 move on June 7–8 with each team packing its own area, and the design team packing after its June 10 deadline for the last items · 2 keep the \$12,000 stand, add online booking and ask for two quotes by Friday · 3

a Saturday rota (maximum two per driver) plus a customer email with holiday dates · 4 one in-person day plus a short online follow-up session on the new ordering software. Any reasonable decision is fine: the task is the process and the action points, not the "right" answer.

◆ SELF - CHECK

Q1

A colleague is speaking, but you have an urgent point. Most professional way to come in?

A) "Sorry to interrupt, but can I just come in here?"

B) "Stop, I want to say something."

C) Say nothing and hope to raise it later.

Why: it signals the interruption before taking the floor, so it feels like teamwork. B is a command; C means the urgent point never lands.

Q2

Which one is a complete action point?

A) "We should look at the budget."

B) "Priya — circulate the updated budget — by Friday."

C) "Budget: discussed."

Why: B has who, what and by when. A has no person and no deadline; C records a discussion, not an action.

Q3

Which phrase does the chair use to close the meeting?

A) "First on the agenda is..."

B) "To recap the action points, ..."

C) "Could you expand on that?"

Why: recapping the action points is the chair's closing job. A opens the first item; C is a participant's clarification question.

Which sentence is correct?

A) I suggest to wait until Monday.

B) How about to wait until Monday?

C) I'd suggest we wait until Monday.

Why: *suggest (that) we + base verb*. Correct versions of A and B: *I suggest waiting...* · *How about waiting...?*

◆ ERRORS TO EXPECT IN 2.1

- ◆ *I am agree* · *Are you agree?* → *I agree* · *Do you agree?*
- ◆ *discuss about* · *make a meeting* · *assist a meeting* → *discuss* · *have / hold a meeting* · *attend a meeting*
- ◆ *I suggest to...* · *How about to...?* → *I suggest -ing / that we + verb* · *How about -ing?*
- ◆ Action points without a person or a deadline ("Check the photos.")
- ◆ Correct words with flat, fast intonation that sounds impatient: drill again, contrasting flat and polite.

2.2 · SMALL TALK, NETWORKING & BUILDING RAPPORT (C6)

◆ EXERCISE 1 – TWO CONVERSATIONS AT A COFFEE BREAK (SCRIPT 2.2-A)

Version 1 stops because: the questions are closed ("Are you enjoying...?"), the answers are one word, nobody gives free information, and the topics jump (expo → busy → weather) instead of following up.

Hamid's opener	"This line for coffee is quite something, isn't it?" (shared situation + falling tag)
Follow-up questions (any two)	"What did you think of it?" · "How's that going?" · "How did you get into route planning?" (Joanna) · "What do you miss most?"
Joanna's free information	her company is changing its tracking system · it's a food company, so everything must arrive fresh · she was a chemistry teacher for ten years
Hamid's free information	he plans delivery routes ("probably one of the people causing your delays!") · he trained as a civil engineer and started in a warehouse
Common ground	both changed careers (also accept: both are interested in delivery tracking)
Contacts	they swap business cards (Hamid's email is on the back)
Joanna's exit line	"I should go and say hello to a few people before the next session, but it was really good to meet you."
Next step	Hamid will send information about the new tracking tool this week.

◆ EXERCISE 2 – OPEN IT UP (MODELS)

- 1 What are you enjoying most (about the conference) so far? / How are you finding the conference?

- 2 What do you enjoy most about your job / role? / How did you get into your line of work?
- 3 How was your trip in? / How did you get here today?
- 4 What did you think of the keynote?
- 5 What are you working on at the moment?
- 6 How do you know the host?

Also accept any *How / What / Which / Why* question with correct word order. **Expect:** "*What you think of the keynote?*" (missing auxiliary *did*), "*How was your journey?*" (fine: British *journey* = American *trip*).

◆ EXERCISE 3 – SAFE OR RISKY?

Safe: 1 the event · 2 food and coffee · 4 how they got into their field · 6 weekend plans · 9 their trip. **Risky:** 3 earnings · 5 religion · 7 age · 8 gossip about a competitor · 10 health. **"It depends"** (discussion, no single answer): family (warm and normal in some cultures, too personal in others: wait for them to mention it); sport (usually safe, but some rivalries are strong); the weather (always safe, but a dead end unless you follow up). The key strategy: start safe, watch the response, follow their lead.

◆ EXERCISE 4 – RESCUE THE DEAD-END REPLY (MODELS)

- 1 "I'm an accountant — I mostly work with small businesses, which keeps it interesting. How about you?"
- 2 "Not really, just an hour on the train, so not bad. Are you local, or did you travel in?"
- 3 "Really well, thanks — the session on remote teams was great. What's been your highlight?"
- 4 "We worked together at a design agency a few years ago. How about you? How do you know her?"

Each answer should add **free information** and hand a **question back**. Role-card details are fine. **Expect:** free information that is too personal too soon (salary, family problems): praise the idea, suggest a work or event detail instead.

◆ EXERCISE 5 – THE GRACEFUL EXIT

1	✗ honest but rude: it insults the other person	4	✓ warm, and turns the exit into a connection
2	✓ warm + light reason + stay in touch	5	✓ light, face-saving reason + warm close
3	✗ the silent vanish feels like a snub	6	✗ too abrupt and cold: no thanks, no warmth

◆ THE MODEL FOLLOW-UP EMAIL – LABEL THE PARTS

Paragraph 1 = **A** (reminder: where they met + something specific: career changes and fresh-food deliveries) · paragraph 2 = **B** (keeps the promise: "As promised, I've attached...") · paragraph 3 = **C** (a light next step: a short call, "No pressure at all") · the sign-off = **D** (name + role + company). Point out: it was sent the **next day** (within 48 hours), and it is neutral and warm, not formal.

◆ NETWORKING TOOLKIT AND FOLLOW-UP EMAIL – MODEL

Toolkit example: opener "Have you been to one of these before?" · topics: the sessions, the trip in, weekend plans · introduction "Hi, I'm Rosa. I lead a small team at Tidewater Packaging, and we're planning our training day, so I'm here for ideas!" · exit "I won't keep you. It was really good to meet you. Let's stay in touch."

Model follow-up (about 75 words): *Subject: Great to meet you this morning · Hi Daniel, It was great to meet you at the Riverside Business Breakfast today, and congratulations again on your first half marathon! I really enjoyed hearing how you put together the monthly booking reports. I'd love to hear more about the tool you use: would you have time for a quick coffee or a call next week? No pressure at all. Best regards, Rosa Delgado, Team Leader, Tidewater Packaging*

Check: reminder of where they met · one specific reference · a light, low-pressure next step · a neutral, warm register. **Expect:** "I am writing to inform you that I met you" (too formal), "Dear Mr. Daniel" (use *Hi Daniel* or *Dear Mr. Novak*), no specific detail ("Nice to meet you. Let's keep in touch." only), or a hard sell in the first message.

◆ SELF-CHECK

Q1

Which opener invites a real answer?

A) "Are you enjoying it?"

B) "What's been the most useful session for you so far?"

C) "Nice weather."

Why: an open *What* question needs a full answer and gives you something to follow up. A is closed ("Yes."); C is a statement that is hard to continue.

Q2

Which topic is the safest with someone you have just met?

A) their salary

B) the event and the venue

C) whether they are married and have children

Why: the event is shared, neutral ground. Money is risky in most workplace cultures; family status is normal in some cultures but intrusive in many, so wait for them to raise it.

Q3 · new

"What do you do?" Which answer builds rapport best?

A) "I'm in logistics."

B) "I'm in logistics — I actually moved over from teaching last year, so it's all quite new. How about you?"

C) "Why do you ask?"

Why: answer + free information + question back. A is a dead end; C sounds suspicious.

When is the best time to send a follow-up message?

A) within 24–48 hours

B) after about a month

C) only if they contact you first

Why: while you are still fresh in their memory. After a month, the connection has usually faded.

◆ ERRORS TO EXPECT IN 2.2

- ◆ Missing auxiliaries in questions: *What you think...? · How you got into...? → What do you think...? · How did you get into...?*
- ◆ *I am working here since 2019 / since three years → I've worked / I've been working here since 2019 / for three years*
- ◆ *Nice to meet you* to someone already met → *Nice to see you again*
- ◆ Rising intonation on tags that expect agreement (it sounds like a real, uncertain question)
- ◆ Over-formal follow-ups ("Kindly find attached," "I remain at your disposal") and title + first name (*Mr. Hamid*)

2.3 · DIPLOMATIC & ASSERTIVE COMMUNICATION (C7)

◆ WARM-UP – THE VOICEMAIL (SCRIPT 2.2-B)

Name and company	Mei Lin, Kestrel Design	Where you met	the Riverside Business Breakfast, on Tuesday
What you talked about	your team's new brochure, and running	What she wants	to continue the conversation about designing the brochure: a call back (or an email)
Phone	555-0147 (email: mei.lin@kestreldesign.example)	When she's free	Thursday afternoon or Friday morning

Call-back model: "Hi Mei, it's Sam from Riverside Community Services, returning your call. Thanks for the message, and yes, the 10K went well! About the brochure: we'd love to see some of your work. Could we set up a video call on Friday morning, say 10:00?" **Expect:** "*I call you back*" (→ *I'm returning your call / I'm calling you back*); 0147 read as "zero-one-four-seven" (fine) or "one hundred forty-seven" (unclear on the phone).

◆ EXERCISE 1 – TWO WAYS TO GIVE FEEDBACK (SCRIPT 2.3-A)

a) The strong version: it is specific, fair, about the work (not the person), includes a real positive, asks for Daniel's view and offers a solution. The weak version says "always," judges the person ("be more organized"), gives nothing specific to act on, and ends with a hollow compliment.

honest positive	the new chart on delivery times (the client really liked it)
Situation	the monthly report, in the last two months

Behavior	it reached Rosa on the morning it was due, not the day before
Impact	no time to check the figures before it goes to the client; one number in last month's summary was wrong
question	"How do you feel the process is going from your side?"
proposal	ask the warehouse for the data two days earlier, so Daniel can send the draft the afternoon before
receiving phrase	"Thanks for telling me." (also accept "I didn't realize it was causing a problem" or "That would work")

◆ EXERCISE 2 – PASSIVE, AGGRESSIVE OR ASSERTIVE?

1	P (says yes, but signals resentment; no real request)	5	Ag (dismisses the idea bluntly, offers nothing)
2	As (firm concern, respectful, invites discussion)	6	As (honest about capacity, offers an alternative)
3	Ag ("always" + blaming the person)	7	P (over-apologizes and drops the point)
4	P (hides a real problem)	8	As (behavior-focused, invites problem-solving)

◆ EXERCISE 3 – ADD A SOFTENER (MODELS)

- 1 I think we might be underestimating the timeline.
- 2 I have a slight concern about the budget. (also: a small concern / a bit of a concern)
- 3 Would it be possible to push the deadline back a week? (also: Could we push...?)
- 4 I was hoping we could revisit the deadline. / I was wondering if we could revisit the deadline.
- 5 I can definitely get you the draft by Thursday.
- 6 I take your point, but I'm not sure that's the best approach, because... (also: With respect, I'd suggest a different approach.)

Expect: *I was wondering if we **can**...* (accept in speech, but teach *could*); item 5 rewritten negatively ("Sorry, only Thursday"): the move is to say what you **can** do; item 6 with the preface but no reason (the reason is what keeps it firm).

◆ EXERCISE 4 – REWRITE THE BLUNT MESSAGES (MODELS)

- 1 **To your manager:** "I can see why this client is attractive, but I have some concerns about taking them on. Their project is small and needs a lot of changes, so it might take time from our bigger accounts. Could we look at the numbers together before we decide?"
- 2 **To a colleague:** "I'd love to help, but I can't cover your shift on Saturday: I already have plans I can't move. I could swap with you next week, though, or I can ask in the team chat if anyone else is free. Would that help?"
- 3 **To a teammate:** "Can I share some feedback? In Tuesday's meeting, you came in a couple of times while Sara was still explaining the budget, and she didn't get to finish her point. Your ideas were really useful, so it would be great to hear them after she's done. How did you feel the meeting went?"

- 4 **To a supplier:** "I appreciate your team's work on our account, but I need to raise a concern. This is the third order this month with a mistake: this time, 50 boxes were the wrong size. Could we look at what's going wrong and agree how to prevent it? Could you send me a plan by Friday?"

Judge by: acknowledge first · one or two softeners · the **real message stays** (the "no" is still a no; the complaint still asks for a fix) · a **way forward** (alternative, proposal, deadline) · no blame words (*always, never, you're...*). Message 3 should be SBI and behavior-focused; message 4 should be firm and specific, with a clear request and deadline. **Expect:** passive rewrites that lose the message ("It's fine, maybe next time"), and "Kindly do the needful" style formulas in message 4.

◆ EXERCISE 5 – CALMING A COMPLAINT (SCRIPT 2.3-B)

a) The linen delivery to the hotel was late again (the second time this month): it was due at 7:00 and arrived at 9:40, and guests were waiting for their rooms.

Order	Step	Sam's phrase
3	common ground	"We both want your deliveries to arrive on time, every day."
4	a way forward	"Here's what I'd suggest as a way forward..." (+ "Would that work for you?")
1	acknowledge the feeling	"You're right to raise it. I can see why you'd feel frustrated." (also accept "I'm sorry about that")
2	the problem, not the person	"Let's focus on fixing the problem rather than who's at fault."

c) Sam will find out where the delay happened and call Ms. Kovacs back **by 4 p.m. today** with a plan; from **next week**, customers get a text message when the truck leaves the warehouse. **Notice:** Sam checks understanding ("Let me make sure I've understood you correctly") and doesn't blame the driver.

◆ HARD-CONVERSATION PLANNER – WHAT A GOOD OPENING SOUNDS LIKE

Card 2 (push back on a deadline): "I understand the client wants it early next week, and I want to get it right for them. Realistically, a full report needs until Friday. Would it be possible to send a one-page summary on Wednesday and the full report on Friday?" **Card 3 (SBI):** "Is now a good time for some feedback? Your analysis in the weekly report is really strong. This month, the report arrived after the deadline three times, and last week one figure was wrong, which meant I had to correct it before the client saw it. How are you finding the process at the moment?"

◆ SELF-CHECK

Q1

A colleague suggests an approach you think is risky. Which response is assertive?

A) "Sure, sounds good, let's go with yours." (while privately worried)

B) "That's a bad idea, it'll never work."

C) "I see it a little differently — I'm worried about the support cost. Can we look at it together?"

Why: it names the concern with a reason and invites discussion. A is passive (swallows the concern); B is aggressive.

Q2 • new

Which sentence is about behavior, not the person?

A) "You're careless."

B) "The last two reports arrived after the deadline."

C) "You never care about deadlines."

Why: B describes something observable. A judges character; C uses "never" and guesses at feelings.

Q3

You really can't take on a request. Which reply is best?

A) "I'd love to help, but I'm at capacity this week. I could review the draft on Friday if that's useful?"

B) "No, ask someone else."

C) "Um, okay, I'll try to squeeze it in somehow..." (knowing you can't)

Why: honest about capacity, warm, and offers a partial alternative. B closes the door; C is a passive yes that will damage trust later.

Q4 • new

A client is angry about a late delivery. What should you do first?

A) explain whose fault it was

B) acknowledge the feeling

C) offer a discount immediately

Why: a person who feels heard becomes reasonable. Blame (A) makes it worse; a discount (C) may be part of the solution later, but it skips listening and may promise more than you can give.

◆ ERRORS TO EXPECT IN 2.3

- ◆ Over-softening that hides the message: "I was just perhaps wondering if it might possibly be a slight concern..." → one softener + the point + a reason.
- ◆ Over-direct modals: *You must send it today · I want you send...* → *Could you send it today? It's holding up the client report.*
- ◆ *I was wondering if we can...* → *could*; *Would it be possible that you send...* → *Would it be possible for you to send.../to get...*
- ◆ Feedback about the person (*you're lazy, you're not professional*) instead of the behavior; "always / never."
- ◆ Archaic formulas in complaints: *Kindly do the needful · Please revert back* → *Could you... · Please let me know by...*

MIDPOINT PERFORMANCE CHECK — WORKBOOK PAGE (C8–C9)

◆ WHAT TO LOOK FOR

There are no right answers on this page. The self-ratings before the check are for the learner's reflection only; do not collect or grade them. After C9, check that each learner has copied both scores (**Writing /20** and **Speaking /20**) and their one or two targets from the score sheet into the **Performance Tracker**, and that the "before → after" sentence really improves the original (usually register, a clearer request, or a missing detail such as a day or time). The rubric, Part A model answers, speaking card notes and the "From Scores to Targets" method are in [assessment/assessment-key.html](#); the per-learner score sheets and the Reading & Ranking task are in [assessment/performance-check.html](#). The extra quiet task's suggested ranking (B, D, C, A, E) is in the materials, Set F.

Module 3 — Presenting, Negotiating & Persuading: Answers

Answers to every Module 3 workbook exercise and self-check question, with the "why," acceptable alternatives, model answers for the open tasks (a 2-minute presentation, a confirmation email, a pitch with objection handling, an elevator pitch), the Deal Room points guide, and the errors you can expect to meet most.

Lessons 3.1–3.3

Classes C9–C11

9 self-check items

15 exercises • 5 models

MARKING PRINCIPLE

Speaking and persuasion have **criteria**, not single answers. For closed items (matching, ordering, verb forms, feature vs benefit) there is one best answer and the key gives it. For open items (rewrites, trades, pitches, emails), the models are *examples*. Accept any version that (1) does the job the task sets (a reason + a way forward; an *if* on every concession; a benefit that is a payoff for the listener, not another fact), (2) is accurate (*If you pay...*, *we'll...*, not *If you will pay*), and (3) sits in a polite, professional register. Refer to the course's four criteria when you comment: **Task & Purpose, Register & Tone, Language Range & Accuracy, Organization & Delivery**. American English is the model; accept British spellings and forms (*organised, summarise, levelled off, licence, programme, offence*), and accept any currency.

3.1 • PRESENTATIONS — STRUCTURE & DELIVERY (C9)

◆ MY MIDPOINT TARGET IN MODULE 3

No answers: each learner's target is private. Check two things as you circulate: the target matches the learner's score sheet (and is copied into section 4 of the Performance Tracker; see "From Scores to Targets" in [assessment/assessment-key.html](#)), and the "one action" is **observable**. ✗ "Improve my English." ✗ "Speak better." ✓ "In every talk I'll use one signpost between each point and pause after it." ✓ "Every email I write ends with an action and a date."

◆ EXERCISE 1 — THE FIVE JOBS (TOMÁS'S OPENING)

1 greeting **a** • 2 introduce yourself **b** • 3 hook **c** • 4 topic + purpose + benefit **d** • 5 outline **e** • 6 housekeeping **f**

7 A **question** followed by a **striking fact** (52 days). Accept "a question" or "a surprising number." • 8 **At the end** ("I'll take any questions at the end").

◆ EXERCISE 2 — PUT THE OPENING IN ORDER (AMIRA)

2 → 5 → 4 → 6 → 1 → 3: greeting ("Good afternoon...") → introduce ("I'm Amira Haddad...") → hook ("In January, one delivery in five...") → topic + purpose ("Today I'd like to show you...") → outline ("two parts...") → housekeeping ("Please feel free to ask...").

Also accept the hook after the topic (2 → 5 → 6 → 4 → 1 → 3), and the hook first, before the greeting, for confident learners: some presenters open cold with a fact. Not acceptable: the outline before the topic, or housekeeping in the middle.

◆ EXERCISE 3 — CHOOSE THE SIGNPOST

1 **b** (moving on) · 2 **a** (giving an example) · 3 **b** (referring back) · 4 **a** (referring forward: "We'll come to that shortly") · 5 **b** (emphasizing) · 6 **a** (summarizing)

Why the distractors fail: *In conclusion* ends the whole talk, so it can't introduce point two · *So much for cost* means "I've finished talking about cost," the opposite of item 4 · *Last but not least* introduces the final point, not a look back · *Firstly* starts a list.

◆ EXERCISE 4 – DESCRIBE THE CHART

Listening (Script 3.1-B): the two wrong figures are "79%" in Q1 (the chart says 81%) and "95%" in Q3 (the chart says 93%).

Gap-fill: 1 shows · 2 If you look at · 3 rose steadily · 4 rose sharply · 5 peaked at · 6 leveled off · 7 What this tells us is

3 and 4 are the only pair that could be confused: 81 → 84 over a quarter is small and even (*steadily*); 84 → 93 is big and fast (*sharply*). Accept British *levelled off*.

◆ EXERCISE 5 – FROM SLIDE-READING TO SPEAKING (MODELS)

- 1 "This slide shows customer complaints over the last two years. If you look at the 2024 figure, you'll see complaints fell sharply, from 240 to 130, almost half. What this tells us is that the new returns process is working."
- 2 "I'd like to draw your attention to fuel. As you can see, it makes up almost half of our costs, at 45%, and drivers are another third. Repairs are only 12%. The takeaway here is that a small saving on fuel would have the biggest impact."
- 3 "This graph shows visits to our website this year. Notice how they tripled between January and June, from about 3,000 to 9,000. In other words, the new online catalog is bringing people in, so now we need to turn those visits into orders."

Accept any version with the four steps: introduce · direct attention · describe the trend (with at least one accurate figure) · interpret. **Watch for:** reading every number; interpretation missing; ✗ *the complaints were decreased* (✓ fell / decreased); ✗ *the 45% of costs* (✓ 45% of our costs).

◆ DIALOGUE – A QUESTION YOU CAN'T ANSWER

(a) buy time: "That's a great question." · (b) clarify: "Just to make sure I understand: do you mean the monthly fee, or the setup cost as well?" · (c) promise a follow-up: "I don't have the setup cost to hand, but I'll check with finance and follow up by Thursday." · (d) park: "That's a bit outside today's scope, I'm afraid. Can we take that offline?"

◆ PRESENTATION CAROUSEL – A MODEL 2-MINUTE TALK (ROLE PROFILE: AMIRA)

"Good afternoon, everyone, and thanks for coming. I'm Amira Haddad, and I coordinate operations here at Northwind. In January, one delivery in five arrived late. In October, it was one in fourteen. Today I'd like to show you how that happened, and why I think we should use the new route plan in every region. I've divided my talk into two parts: what changed, and what we should do next. Please feel free to ask questions as we go.

Let's start with what changed. In July we started using a route-planning app in the North region. **As you can see from this chart**, on-time deliveries rose steadily in the first half of the year, from 81% to 84%. Then, in Q3, they rose sharply and peaked at 93%. **What this tells us is** that the app, not the season, made the difference. **For instance**, one driver cut forty minutes from her morning route.

This brings me to my next point: what we should do next. **The key point here is** that the other regions still plan routes by hand. **So, to sum up:** the app works, it's already paid for in one region, and it could work everywhere. I'd like your approval to try it in two more regions next month. Thank you. Are there any questions?"

What makes it work (for your feedback): Task & Purpose: a clear request at the end · Register & Tone: neutral-professional, "you"-focused · Language: trend verbs used accurately · Organization & Delivery: five jobs, a signpost at every turn, about 260 words ≈ 2 minutes at presentation speed.

◆ SELF-CHECK 3.1

Q1

Moving from the problem to the solution: which signpost?

A) "That's the problem. This brings me to my solution..."

B) "In conclusion, here's my solution..."

C) "As I mentioned earlier, here's my solution..."

Why: "This brings me to..." moves forward to the next point. *In conclusion* signals the end of the talk; *As I mentioned earlier* refers back.

Q2

A question you don't have the numbers for?

A) A long, general answer.

B) "That's not really relevant to my talk."

C) "I don't have that figure to hand, but I'll follow up with you by tomorrow."

Why: honest, short and committed to a follow-up. A damages credibility (guessing, waffling); B sounds defensive and dismissive.

Q3 · new

The best way to present a chart of costs?

A) "This slide shows a table of costs."

B) "As you can see, costs fell sharply in Q2. What this tells us is that the new supplier is saving us money."

C) Read every number from top to bottom.

Why: B introduces, describes the trend and interprets it. A only labels the slide; C reads it and loses the audience.

ERRORS YOU WILL MEET MOST (3.1)

✗ *I will present you my project* · ✗ *Today I will talk about to reduce costs* · ✗ *discuss about* · ✗ *In conclusion* used mid-talk · ✗ *rised* / *was risen* / *the sales was growing up* · ✗ *the 45% of costs* · decimal commas (2,5 million) · *fifteen / fifty* confusion · no purpose or benefit stated · two points with no signpost between them · reading from notes · rambling answers in Q&A. For range, praise a real hook, *This brings me to...* with a pause, *What this tells us is...*, and a calm "I'll follow up."

3.2 · NEGOTIATIONS — LANGUAGE & STRATEGY (C10)

◆ MODEL DIALOGUE — TWENTY DESKS

- 1 **Position:** all twenty desks by the 1st. **Interest:** a new team of twelve starts on the 1st and needs somewhere to sit.
- 2 "Can I ask what's driving the 1st?" (also: "So it's twelve desks that are urgent, not all twenty?" checks the interest)
- 3 "If you can accept two deliveries, we'll send twelve desks by the 1st..." → Rafael gets flexibility on delivery (two drops instead of one rush). "If you pay within 14 days, I'll waive the second charge..." → he gets faster payment.
- 4 "I'm afraid we can't cover both, because our drivers are fully booked that week. What we could offer instead is half price on the second delivery."
- 5 "That's a big step for us, honestly."
- 6 **Open:** "Thanks for making the time..." · **Explore:** "Can I ask what's driving the 1st?" · **Propose and bargain:** "Then here's an idea. If you can accept two deliveries..." · **Close:** "Wonderful. So, to confirm..." (Preparing happened before the meeting.)

◆ EXERCISE 1 — NAME THE MOVE

1 **Open** · 2 **Probe** · 3 **Propose** · 4 **Reject** · 5 **Concede** (a conditional concession) · 6 **Accept** · 7 **Close** (summarizing) · 8 **Probe** · 9 **Accept** · 10 **Close** (next steps, in writing)

Accept **Propose** for 5 if the learner argues "I'll need something in return" invites a trade; the key idea is that it isn't a free concession.

◆ EXERCISE 2 — DON'T GIVE IT AWAY: TRADE IT (MODELS)

- 1 "We can include free shipping **if** you increase the order to 500 units." / "...as long as you order before the end of the month."
- 2 "We can start a week earlier **provided that** you sign the contract by Friday." / "...if you can be flexible on the final deadline."
- 3 "If you commit to a two-year contract, we'll add two extra training days."
- 4 "We could extend payment to 60 days **if** you place a repeat order in the spring." / "...as long as the first order is paid in full on delivery."

Accept any version that attaches a real condition and asks for something of value in return. ✗ "If you want, we'll give free shipping" (the *if* asks for nothing). ✗ "If you will order 500..."

◆ EXERCISE 3 — A REAL OFFER OR TESTING THE WATER?

- 1 **commit** · **'ll reduce** / **will reduce** (also *can reduce*) · **R**
- 2 **offered** · **would you consider** · **T**
- 3 **'ll hold** / **will hold** / **can hold** · **order** · **R**
- 4 **extended** · **would that help** · **T**
- 5 **were** · **would you expect** · **T**

6 unless · R (a real condition)

Watch for: ✗ *If you will commit* · ✗ *as long as you will order* · ✗ *If you was to double* (accept *was* in speech from strong learners, but teach *were* as the safer form) · ✗ *If we would offer*.

◆ EXERCISE 4 – SAY NO WITHOUT CLOSING THE DOOR (MODELS)

- 1 "I'm afraid 20% is more than we can do, because our margins on this product are already very tight. What we could offer instead is 8%, if you commit to a year."
- 2 "I don't think we can manage Saturday, unfortunately, because our warehouse is closed on weekends. We could deliver first thing on Friday or Monday morning. Would either of those work?"
- 3 "I understand where you're coming from, but that price is a little higher than our budget allows. Could we look at a smaller first order, or a longer contract, to bring it down?"

Each answer needs a **softener** (*I'm afraid, unfortunately, I understand...but*), a **reason** (*because...*) and a **way forward** (an alternative or a question). Register: no *Forget it*, no bare *No*.

◆ EXERCISE 5 – FROM POSITION TO INTEREST (MODELS)

- 1 "Can you help me understand what's behind the 10%? Is it a fixed budget, or a lower quote from someone else?"
- 2 "What's making the 30th so important? Is it a launch, or something later that we could plan around?"
- 3 "Can I ask why one year works better for you? Is it about flexibility, or about cost?"

Accept any open, polite question that asks **why**. Offering two possible reasons ("Is it X or Y?") makes it easier to answer. ✗ "Why do you want this?" in a flat tone can sound suspicious: add *Can I ask...* or *Can you help me understand...*

◆ DEAL ROOM – POINTS GUIDE (TEACHER ONLY)

Walk-away score on every card = **40 points**. "Meet in the middle" = the middle option on every issue (scenario 3 has only two date options). "Win-win" = each side gives way on the issues it cares less about.

Scenario	A "meet in the middle" deal (no exploring)	A + B points	A win-win deal	A + B points
1 • Delivery contract (A Brightline Foods · B Northwind Logistics)	\$170 · 2 years · 30 days · 7–10 a.m.	50 + 80 = 130	\$160 · 3 years · 30 days · before 7 a.m.	80 + 90 = 170
2 • Launch deadline (A Marketing · B Digital team, Maple & Stone)	March 15 · 4 features · \$5,000 · 2 weeks' testing	50 + 55 = 105	March 1 · 3 features · \$5,000 · 3 weeks' testing	70 + 80 = 150
3 • Training venue (A Silverleaf Clinics · B Harbor Point)	\$1,800 · Thu–Fri · coffee only · 25%	55 + 43 = 98	\$1,800 · Mon–Tue · full lunch · 25%	80 + 90 = 170

Why the win-win works: (1) Northwind's drivers start at 5 a.m. anyway, so an early window costs them almost nothing, and Brightline is happy with a long contract because it plans to grow. (2) Marketing only needs three features for the trade show;

the digital team only fears building five in time. (3) Harbor Point's Mondays and Tuesdays are empty; lunch costs its in-house kitchen very little, and Silverleaf cares most about feeding 60 staff. Pairs who asked "What's most important to you?" usually find these. Any deal above 40 for both sides is a valid result; "no deal" is 0 + 0.

◆ CONFIRMATION EMAIL — MODEL (SCENARIO 1, FROM NORTHWIND'S SIDE; 112 WORDS)

Subject: Confirming our agreement — store deliveries

Hi Tomás,

Thanks for a productive conversation today. Just to confirm what we agreed:

- a price of \$160 per delivery
- a three-year contract, starting on March 1
- payment within 30 days of each invoice
- all deliveries to arrive before 7 a.m.

I'll send the contract over by Friday for your review. Please let me know if I've captured anything incorrectly.

It's been a pleasure working this out with you, and I'm looking forward to a long partnership.

Best regards,

Amira

Check with the criteria: **Task & Purpose:** all four terms, a next step with a date · **Register & Tone:** warm, neutral-professional (not *Kindly do the needful*, not *Hey!*) · **Language:** *by Friday* (✗ until Friday), articles (*a three-year contract*) · **Organization:** subject line, bullet points, close.

◆ SELF-CHECK 3.2

Q1

The strongest conditional trade?

A) "OK, fine, we'll take another 5% off."

B) "We could do another 5% if you commit to a two-year contract."

C) "No, that's the price. Take it or leave it."

Why: B attaches an *if* and gets something back. A gives the concession away and teaches the buyer that pushing works; C slams the door and risks deadlock.

Q2

The best way to close?

A) Shake hands and leave.

B) Ask for one more concession.

C) Summarize, confirm, and send the details by email.

Why: a deal isn't done until it's summarized and written down. A leaves the terms vague; B reopens a settled deal and damages goodwill.

Q3 · new

"If you signed today, would you expect a discount?"

A) A firm offer.

B) Testing the water without promising anything.

C) A rejection.

Why: the second conditional (*If + past, would*) is hypothetical: the speaker explores what the buyer wants without committing. A firm offer would be "If you sign today, we'll take 5% off."

ERRORS YOU WILL MEET MOST (3.2)

✗ *If you will sign...* · ✗ *as long as you will pay* · ✗ *I want you give me discount* · ✗ *give discount* (article) · ✗ *I am agree* · ✗ *discuss about the price* · ✗ *until Friday* for a deadline · a bare "No" or "Impossible" · free concessions ("OK, OK, free shipping") · proposing before asking any questions · agreeing to everything to be polite · a deal with no summary. For range, praise *What's driving that?*, a well-placed second conditional, a labeled concession, and a clean spoken summary.

3.3 · PITCHING, PERSUASION & HANDLING OBJECTIONS (C11)

◆ MODEL PITCH (AMIRA)

(1) hook / problem · (2) solution · (3) benefit · (4) evidence · (5) call to action

Why the ask is easy to say yes to: it's specific (two regions, one month), low-risk (a trial, not a full rollout), and it includes a review ("review the numbers together"), so the director stays in control.

◆ EXERCISE 1 – FEATURE OR BENEFIT?

1 F · 2 B · 3 F · 4 B · 5 F · 6 B · 7 F · 8 B

Each odd item is a fact about the product; each even item is its payoff for a person. Point out the pattern: benefits usually start with **you / your**.

◆ EXERCISE 2 – BUILD THE BRIDGE (MODELS)

- 1 "...which means that fewer people forget their bookings, so rooms don't sit empty while others are looking for one."
- 2 "...so that your cafés can order once a week and throw away far less food."
- 3 "...which means that your staff can arrive by train without worrying about parking."
- 4 "...so that your team spends its time on the difficult questions, and customers get simple answers in seconds, even at night."

Accept any bridge that ends in a **human payoff** (time, money, stress, reputation). ✗ "...which means that it sends reminders automatically" (the feature again).

◆ EXERCISE 3 – ORDER THE PITCH AND ADD THE ASK

b → d → c → a: hook/problem → solution → benefit → evidence.

Model call to action: "Could we switch on online booking at two more clinics for three months and compare the waiting times?" Also good: "I'd love your go-ahead to add it to the Westside clinic next month." A strong ask is **specific** (where, how long), **low-risk** (a trial) and asks for **one** next step. ✗ "So... what do you think?"

◆ EXERCISE 4 – ANSWER THE OBJECTION

A. 1 reframe to value (ROI) · **2 show what's different** (differentiate) · **3 the cost of waiting** (cost of inaction; also accept "offer a trial at a better time") · **4 find the real concern**

B. Models: 1 "That's a fair concern: budgets are tight. Can I ask whether it's the total cost or the monthly cost that's the problem?" · 4 "Of course, it's an important decision. Can I ask what's giving you pause? Is it the price, the timing, or something else?"

Both lines must **acknowledge** before they **ask**, and neither should argue or answer yet. ✗ "But it's cheap!" ✗ "What is your problem?" (sounds rude: use *Can I ask what's driving that?*)

◆ EXERCISE 5 – CONFIDENT, NOT OVER-HYPED (MODELS)

- 1 "In our six-month pilot with three small shops, the app cut stock-taking time by about a third, and two of them saw sales rise by around 10%."
- 2 "More than forty businesses in our region already use it. The sooner you start, the sooner you'll see the time savings, and we can set it up for you this month."
- 3 "It's very reliable: in the last year it was available 99.9% of the time, and if anything goes wrong, our support team answers 24 hours a day."

Replace absolute claims (*best, guaranteed, never, everybody*) with **specific, hedged evidence** (*in our pilot, about, around, more than forty*) and honest urgency. Accept any invented figures that are plausible and marked as the learner's example.

◆ DIALOGUE – "WE ALREADY USE SPREADSHEETS"

Listen: the seller lets the client finish ("It looks nice, but..."). · **Acknowledge:** "That's a fair point. Spreadsheets are flexible." · **Ask:** "Can I ask what you like most about them?" and "Just so I understand: is the main worry learning a new tool, or losing your old data?" · **Respond:** "We import all your old spreadsheets for you, free of charge... Would it help if we tested it with last month's expenses first?" · **Confirm:** "Does that address your concern?"

Real concern: losing five years of data (not the tool itself).

◆ PITCH & PUSH-BACK — A MODEL WITH LAARC (CARD 2: LUNCH BOXES)

Pitcher: You know how your cafés run out of lunch options by one o'clock, and customers walk out? We make ready-to-cook lunch boxes at Brightline Foods: your staff heat them in three minutes. That means you can offer a hot lunch all afternoon without a full kitchen. Cafés in our pilot sold an extra forty lunches a week on average. Could we start with a small order for two of your cafés next month?

Buyer: They look good, but honestly, it's too expensive for us.

Pitcher: That's a fair concern. Can I ask what's driving that: is it the price per box, or the size of the first order?

Buyer: Well, it's more that if we don't sell them, we throw them away. That's money in the bin.

Pitcher: I completely understand. So the real risk is waste. The boxes stay fresh for five days, and for the first month we can offer sale-or-return: you only pay for what you sell. Does that address your concern?

Buyer: If we only pay for what we sell, then yes. Let's try two cafés.

Notice: five stages in under 60 seconds; the objection is acknowledged and clarified before any answer; the hidden concern (waste) is found with one "or" question; the response removes the risk rather than cutting the price.

◆ ELEVATOR PITCH — MODELS (30 SECONDS)

Role profile (Priya Nair): "Hi, I'm Priya. I look after events at Harbor Point Conference Center, near the station. We help companies run training days without the stress: rooms, lunch and equipment all in one booking. Most of our clients rebook within the year. You mentioned your team training in the spring. Could I send you two dates and a price this week?"

An idea at work: "I'm Tomás from accounts. I've got an idea that could get us paid two weeks faster: automatic payment reminders. We tested it on twenty customers last month, and most of them paid on time. Could I have ten minutes at Thursday's team meeting to show you?"

Check the four beats: **who** • **what** • **value** • **ask**. It should sound like the learner, not like a script.

◆ SELF-CHECK 3.3

Q1

Which is a benefit, not a feature?

A) It has a 500-page paper capacity.

B) So you can print all day without stopping to reload paper.

C) It's built with a two-tray design.

Why: B names the payoff for the user (no interruptions). A and C describe what the printer has: features.

Q2

"It's too expensive." The best first move?

A) "That's a fair concern. Can I ask what's driving that: the total or the monthly cost?"

B) "It's actually very reasonable. You're wrong about that."

C) "OK, I'll take 30% off right now."

Why: acknowledge, then clarify: the heart of LAARC. B argues and pushes the client away; C gives away value instantly and suggests the price was never real.

Q3 · new

Which claim is honest and persuasive?

A) "This is guaranteed to double your sales."

B) "In our three-month pilot, the team cut admin time by around 30%."

C) "Everyone in the industry is using it."

Why: B is specific (a pilot, three months), measurable and hedged (*around*). A overpromises; C is vague social proof that the listener can't check.

ERRORS YOU WILL MEET MOST (3.3)

Starting with the product instead of the problem · listing features with no bridge · "which means that" followed by the same feature · no call to action ("...anyway, let me know") · several asks at once · ✗ *It permits to save time* · ✗ *Let me explain you* · ✗ *very unique, more cheaper, most best* · arguing with objections ("You're wrong") · dropping the price at the first objection · over-hyped claims (*guaranteed, the best in the world*). For range, praise a vivid "You know how...?", *Imagine your team no longer having to...*, an "X or Y?" clarifying question, and a confident falling-tone ask.

Module 4 — Business Writing & Career: Answers

Answers to every Module 4 workbook exercise and self-check question, with the "why," acceptable alternatives, model versions of the open writing and speaking tasks, guidance for the Final Assessment page, and the errors you can expect to meet most. Final Assessment tasks, model answers and scoring descriptors are in [assessment/assessment-key.html](#), not here.

Lessons 4.1–4.3 + FA page

Classes C12–C16

12 self-check items

15 exercises

MARKING PRINCIPLE

Many Module 4 tasks are rewrites and open writing, so the models below are *examples*, not the answer. Accept any rewrite that (1) keeps the meaning, (2) fits the register the task asks for (objective document style, a positive interview tone, a formal and warm client tone) and (3) is clear on the first reading. For recommendations and CV bullets, accept any version that is **specific** and uses the facts given; learners should not invent facts that contradict them. Where learners write about their own work history, mark the English only, never the history itself. American English is the model; accept British spellings and forms (*prioritise, organise, programme, behavioural, CV, "We recommend that the team should be expanded"*).

4.1 • REPORTS, PROPOSALS & BUSINESS DOCUMENTS (C12)

◆ MODEL — THE EXECUTIVE SUMMARY (NORTHWIND LOGISTICS)

P (purpose): "This report examines the causes of late deliveries in the Northern Region in the first quarter and recommends a response." • **F** (findings): "Late deliveries rose from 6% to 14%... It was found that two causes account for most of the delay... Notably, 70% of late orders were on Monday and Tuesday routes." • **R** (recommendations): "We recommend three actions: (1)... (2)... (3)..." plus the expected result in the last sentence.

- 1 Three actions: introduce the route-planning software by the end of May, lease a replacement van for the early-week routes, and review driver schedules in Q3. She also knows the expected result (below 6% by July). Accept any answer that names at least the software and the van.
- 2 *Notably.*
- 3 "It was found that..." (also accept "routes are still planned by hand" and "these steps are expected to...").
- 4 Numbering shows priority and order, makes the actions easy to refer to in a meeting ("Let's approve 1 and 2"), and shows they are separate, concrete steps.

◆ EXERCISE 1 — THE FINDINGS BRIEFING (SCRIPT 4.1-A)

1	2	3	4	5	6
---	---	---	---	---	---

400	240	55	25	half (50%)	12 cents (\$0.12)
-----	-----	----	----	------------	-------------------

Report or proposal? A report (Tomás presents findings: what the survey and the trial show). At the end Grace asks him to turn it into a proposal ("Put it in a proposal for Thursday"). Accept "report, then a proposal." **Model finding sentences:** "Complaints doubled from 120 to 240 per quarter." · "Notably, 55% of complaints concern damaged packaging." · "It was found that the new boxes cut damage by half in the Eastfield trial." Check the numbers (*fifty-five*, not *fifteen*) and the verb *concern* / *are about* (✗ *concern about*).

◆ EXERCISE 2 – ORDER THE SECTIONS

A. Report: g Title (1) → b Executive Summary (2) → d Introduction (3) → c Findings (4) → e Conclusions (5) → a Recommendations (6) → f Appendices (7).

B. Proposal: c Background / Problem (1) → e Objectives (2) → f Proposed plan (3) → a Benefits (4) → g Costs, resources & timeline (5) → b Risks (6) → d Recommendation / Call to action (7).

Accept Costs and Risks in either order (5/6), and accept an executive summary placed before Background if a learner adds one to the proposal: long proposals often have one. **Written last, placed first.**

◆ EXERCISE 3 – WHAT DOES THE PHRASE DO?

1	2	3	4	5	6	7	8	9	10
Recommend	Purpose	Findings	Data	Conclusion	Recommend	Findings	Data	Purpose	Conclusion

Signals: *recommended* / *best course of action* (a future action) · *The aim of* / *sets out* (why the document exists) · *indicates* / *Notably* (evidence) · *As shown in Figure / Appendix* (pointing to data) · *On balance* / *suggest* (interpretation). Accept "Data" for item 3 if the learner explains that it reports a figure; the key point is that it reports, and does not interpret or recommend.

◆ EXERCISE 4 – REWRITE FOR A REPORT (MODELS)

- 1 "The data indicates that customer loss was driven mainly by the price increase." / "The analysis suggests that the price increase caused most of the customer loss."
- 2 "It was found that most complaints concern packaging." / "The analysis shows that the majority of complaints relate to packaging."
- 3 "This suggests that the problem is growing." / "It appears that the problem is getting worse."
- 4 "We recommend hiring two additional agents." / "It is recommended that the team be expanded."
- 5 "In the trial, the new supplier's boxes reduced damage by 50%." / "The new supplier's packaging performed significantly better." (A number is better than an adjective.)
- 6 "We recommend adopting the new system to improve efficiency." (27 words → 9, no jargon.)

Not yet: rewrites that keep *I think* / *pretty sure* / *basically* / *way better*; rewrites that become longer and more abstract ("It is our considered opinion that..."); passives that hide the meaning ("It was decided that it should be looked into"). **Errors to expect:** "It was found that most complaints are concerning about packaging," "The datas show," "It is recommended that the team is expand."

◆ EXERCISE 5 – FROM VAGUE TO APPROVABLE

A (models).

- 1 "We recommend introducing the Southern Region's route-planning software for Monday and Tuesday routes by the end of May, with the aim of reducing late deliveries from 14% to below 6%."
- 2 "We propose moving 20% of the social media budget to email campaigns in Q4, as email returned \$6 for every \$1 spent, compared with \$1.50 for social media ads."
- 3 "As a priority, we recommend a two-week buddy program for all new staff, since 40% of order errors are made in employees' first three months."

Check each for S-A-P-C-T: a named action, an owner or a date where possible, a link to the fact given. Numbers may differ (e.g. 15% or 25% of the budget); any plausible, specific choice is fine.

B. 1 be renewed · 2 be moved · 3 should · 4 could · 5 hiring

Accept "should be renewed / should be moved" (common in British English). Don't accept "is renew," "will be renewed" or "to hire" (✗ *We recommend to hire*).

◆ WRITING TASK – EXECUTIVE SUMMARY (MODEL, BRIGHTLINE BRIEF CARD / EXERCISE 1 NOTES)

MODEL · 104 WORDS

Reducing Damaged Online Orders — Brightline Foods

This proposal sets out a plan to reduce customer complaints about online orders. Complaints doubled from 120 to 240 per quarter, and a survey of 400 customers shows that 55% concern damaged packaging. Notably, an eight-week trial at the Eastfield warehouse cut damage by half. We recommend (1) switching all three warehouses to the new boxes by September, at an extra cost of about \$3,600 a quarter; (2) keeping the current supplier as a backup for three months; and (3) reviewing complaint figures in Q4. As refunds for damaged orders currently cost about \$9,000 a quarter, the change is expected to pay for itself.

Mark with the rubric. A strong summary has: the purpose in sentence 1; at least two numbers; numbered or prioritized recommendations; an expected result; no "This report will discuss..."; no *I think*. **Support (B1) target:** purpose + two numbers + two recommendations, about 80 words.

◆ SPEAKING – THE DECISION-MAKER (WHAT USUALLY HAPPENS)

Northwind: year-one cost is \$9,600 (software) + \$14,400 (van lease: \$1,200 × 12) = **\$24,000**; the director can approve only \$15,000 without the board. Good outcomes: "approve with changes" (the software now; the van as phase two, or taken to the board with the penalty savings of about \$36,000 a year as the argument). **Brightline:** about \$3,600 a quarter extra against refunds of about \$9,000 a quarter, of which the trial suggests half can be saved; the decision-maker's concerns are the trial size and supplier reliability (answered by the backup supplier). **Kestrel:** the director approves only if the tool replaces something: writers who mentioned retiring the four spreadsheets get a quick yes. **Clearwater:** the page (\$6,000) fits the one-off budget; the new agent needs a separate hiring decision. Any reasoned decision is correct; praise writers who answered with a number and decision-makers who gave a condition rather than a flat no.

◆ SELF-CHECK

Q1

Which best describes a good executive summary?

A) A short, standalone recap of purpose, key findings and recommendations: written last, placed first.

B) A teaser that lists what the report will discuss.

C) A section that only makes sense after reading the whole document.

Why: busy decision-makers may read only the summary, so it must stand alone and state the conclusions. B withholds the answer; C fails the reader who reads nothing else.

Q2

Which recommendation is most likely to get approved?

A) The company should improve customer support somehow.

B) We must leverage synergies to operationalize a best-in-class support paradigm...

C) We recommend hiring two agents by the end of Q3 to bring wait times below five minutes (see Appendix A).

Why: C is specific, actionable, time-bound, states the benefit and points to the evidence. A is vague; B is jargon that says nothing concrete.

Q3 • new

Which sentence is in formal, objective document style?

A) I'm pretty sure customers left because of the prices.

B) The data indicates that customer loss was driven mainly by price increases.

C) Customers left, basically because stuff got too expensive.

Why: B attributes the claim to evidence and uses neutral vocabulary. A is personal and uncertain in a chatty way; C is informal (*basically, stuff*).

Q4 • new

"Convince me to fund the new training program." What are you writing?

A) A report

B) A proposal

C) A meeting agenda

Why: the manager wants to be persuaded toward a future action and a budget: that's a proposal. A report would present findings; an agenda plans a meeting.

ERRORS YOU WILL MEET MOST (4.1)

"It is recommended that the team is expand / expanded" (✓ *be expanded*) · "We recommend to hire" (✓ *hiring / that we hire*) · "discuss about," "emphasize on" · "informations, researches, feedbacks, equipments" · "14 percents," "an increase of 14%" said as "forty" · "As shown in the Figure 1" · decimal commas (14,5%) · old formulas (*Please find herewith, Kindly do the needful*) · summaries that end before the recommendations · "This report will discuss..." · recommendations with no action, owner or date. For range, praise *Notably, ...* · *This suggests that...* · *As a priority, ...* · *In the short term...; in the longer term...* and any well-formed subjunctive.

4.2 · CVS, COVER LETTERS & JOB INTERVIEWS (C13)

◆ MODEL – THE CV EXTRACT (NADIA FERREIRA)

- 1 Duty bullet: "Responsible for the weekly stock report." Models: "Streamlined the weekly stock report, cutting preparation time from three hours to one." / "Produced a weekly stock report that reduced out-of-stock items by 25%." Any version with an action verb and a plausible result.
- 2 The gap appears as a normal entry, "Career break," with dates, a short reason ("Family responsibilities," with no private detail) and what she did (a 120-hour certificate). It's honest, brief and positive.
- 3 The degree is listed like any other, with the credential evaluation in brackets; the earlier job says "(overseas)" without apology. Both are facts, presented neutrally.
- 4 Any three of: route planning, stock control, staff training, dispatch, logistics, supply chain, warehouse, food distribution.

◆ EXERCISE 1 – TWO ANSWERS, ONE QUESTION (SCRIPT 4.2-A)

S	"Last spring, one of our biggest clients brought their product launch forward by two weeks."
T	"As the project coordinator, I had to get forty store displays designed, printed and delivered..."
A	"So I split the job into daily targets, I asked the printer to run two shifts..., and I checked progress with the team every morning..."
R	"As a result, all forty displays arrived a day early, the launch went ahead on time, and the client has since signed a two-year contract with us."

Joy is the one to hire. **Why Rafael is weaker** (accept any two): no clear situation or task; "we" and "everybody" instead of "I," so we don't know what he did; no specific actions ("we did many things"); no clear result and no number ("in the end it was OK, I think"); he talks about the company, not the story; it ends with a vague claim ("We are very good with deadlines").

◆ EXERCISE 2 – DUTY → ACHIEVEMENT (MODELS)

- 1 "Handled about 50 customer emails a day, maintaining a 95% same-day response rate."
- 2 "Coordinated four company events a year for up to 120 guests, all delivered on budget."
- 3 "Updated and improved the company website, increasing traffic by 25% in six months."
- 4 "Streamlined monthly reporting by automating two spreadsheets, saving the team about six hours a month."

- 5 "Trained 12 new hires, reducing errors in their first three months by 30%."

Accept any strong verb (*answered, resolved, organized, planned, redesigned, automated, onboarded...*). **Not yet:** a bullet starting with I ("I handled...": acceptable in speech, not on a CV), a bullet with no number, or *Responsible for / Helped with* kept at the start. **Errors to expect:** present tense for a past job ("Handle 50 emails"), "maintaining a 95% of response," "increased the traffic of 25%" (✓ *by 25%*).

◆ EXERCISE 3 – THE FOUR PARTS OF A COVER LETTER

a	b	c	d	e	f	g	h
Opening	Why you	Why them	Closing	Why you	Opening	Why them	Closing

Point out that the strong "why you" sentences contain **evidence** (22%) and **the employer's own words** (*process accuracy*), and the "why them" sentences name something **specific** about the company. A sentence that would work for any company isn't targeted enough.

◆ EXERCISE 4 – ORDER THE STAR ANSWER

b → d → e → a → f → c (Situation: b, d · Task: e · Action: a, f · Result: c)

Model for "Tell me about a time you solved a problem" (a role-card version): "(S) In my last role, customers kept calling to ask where their orders were, and our phone waits had grown to over ten minutes. (T) As team lead, I was responsible for bringing the wait time down without extra budget. (A) So I analyzed a week of calls, found that most were about order tracking, and worked with IT to add tracking links to every confirmation email. I also wrote a short FAQ for the website. (R) As a result, tracking calls dropped by about 40% in a month, and average waits fell below five minutes." Accept any answer with a brief S and T, an Action in the first person with at least two steps, and a concrete Result.

◆ EXERCISE 5 – FIX THE WEAK LINE (MODELS)

- 1 **Problem:** generic ("any role") and empty adjectives. → "I'm applying for the Operations Coordinator role because my experience cutting delivery errors by 22% matches your need for someone who can improve process accuracy."
- 2 **Problem:** badmouthing a past employer makes the candidate look like the problem. → "I'd achieved what I could there, and I was looking for a role with more responsibility, which is what drew me to this position."
- 3 **Problem:** a fake weakness; it doesn't show self-awareness. → "I used to find it hard to delegate. Now I agree clear responsibilities at the start of a project and check in regularly, and it's made our team faster."
- 4 **Problem:** "we" hides what the candidate did, and there's no detail. → "I called a short meeting, asked each person to explain their approach, and suggested a quick test to compare the two options."
- 5 **Problem:** having no questions sounds like low interest. → "Yes, thank you. What does success look like in this role in the first six months?" / "What are the next steps in the process?"

◆ WRITING TASK – SUMMARY AND THREE BULLETS (MODEL, ROLE CARD 3: CHRIS MORGAN)

MODEL · APPLYING FOR CUSTOMER SERVICE TEAM LEADER, CLEARWATER HEALTH SUPPLIES

Summary: Customer service team leader with eight years' experience, including five years leading a team of seven in a busy contact center. Skilled in scheduling, coaching and reducing wait times. Returning to full-time work after a planned career break, with a new certificate in customer experience and a strong focus on service quality.

- Led a team of 7 agents, cutting average phone wait times from 9 to 4 minutes in six months.
- Introduced weekly coaching sessions, raising customer satisfaction scores from 81% to 90%.
- Redesigned the shift schedule, reducing overtime costs by 20%.

Check: summary = who + strengths + what they offer, no "hard-working team player"; each bullet = action verb + result; at least two keywords from the advert (*team leader, wait times, scheduling, coaching*).

◆ DIALOGUE — THE END OF AN INTERVIEW

Chris's questions: "What does success look like in this role in the first six months?" and "What are the next steps in the process?" After the first answer, Chris **links it to their own interest** ("That's exactly the kind of project I enjoy"): it shows real engagement and reminds the interviewer of a strength. The close thanks the interviewer and mentions something specific (learning about the team).

◆ SPEAKING — MOCK INTERVIEW TRIOS

No fixed answers. A strong candidate: *Tell me about yourself* in under a minute (present → past → future, ending with this job); a STAR answer with "I" in the Action and a result with a number or a clear outcome; positive language about past employers; one or two genuine questions at the end. For role card 3 or any role card with a gap or an overseas qualification, a short, positive sentence and then back to strengths. Observers should quote, not judge.

◆ SELF-CHECK

Q1

Which is the strongest CV bullet point?

A) Responsible for the sales team and its targets.

B) Led an 8-person sales team to exceed target by 18% in a year.

C) Hard-working salesperson who is great with people.

Why: B starts with an action verb and proves the result with numbers. A is a duty; C is empty adjectives.

Q2

What should the STAR Action step focus on?

A) The specific steps you personally took.

B) A detailed background of the whole company situation.

C) The final outcome and what you learned.

Why: the Action is the longest part and shows what **you** did. B belongs (briefly) in the Situation; C is the Result.

Q3 · new

A candidate mentions their last job. Which sentence is best?

A) "My boss was terrible."

B) "I'd achieved what I could there, and I was looking for a bigger challenge..."

C) "I'd rather not say."

Why: B is positive, honest and forward-looking, and links to the new role. A badmouths a past employer; C sounds like something is hidden. (If the real reason was a layoff or a move, a short neutral sentence is fine: "The company restructured, and my role ended.")

Q4 · new

Your CV shows a two-year gap. What's the best approach?

A) Change the dates so nobody notices.

B) Explain it briefly and positively, and mention anything you did or learned during that time.

C) Give a long, detailed explanation of your private life.

Why: B is honest and keeps the focus on what you offer. A is dishonest and can end an application; C shares more than an employer needs and uses interview time badly.

ERRORS YOU WILL MEET MOST (4.2)

"I have an experience of five years" / "five years of experiences" (✓ *five years' experience*) · "I work there since 2019" (✓ *I've worked there since 2019*) · "responsible of," "in charge for" · CV bullets in the present tense for past jobs · "I am agree with the company values" · "I want this job because I need money" (register) · STAR answers in "we" with no result · rising intonation on every statement · "Do you have any question?" (✓ *questions*) · over-formal openings ("Respected Sir"). For range, praise *streamlined, secured, exceeded, as a result, which led to, I'm particularly drawn to...* and any calm, positive framing of a gap or a change.

4.3 · REVIEW PROJECT — THE COMPLETE BUSINESS COMMUNICATOR (C14)

◆ MY TOOLKIT

No right answers. Check that each learner has circled two strongest and two weakest areas; the weakest two feed the action plan (journal) and the Final Assessment page.

◆ EXERCISE 1 — FIRST CALL, TWO VERSIONS (SCRIPT 4.3-A)

Version 1: problems	Version 2: fixes
First name ("Hi Laura!") without an invitation	Title and surname ("Good morning, Ms. Quinn") and thanks for her time

No rapport: "skip the chit-chat," straight to the numbers	A relationship-first question before business ("how your side is approaching the year")
Pressure for a decision today in a consensus team	"There's no need to decide today," a written summary, and "What timeline would suit you?"

Also accept "Sam missed the soft no" and "idioms / informal phrases (*chit-chat, dive straight in, bottom line*)" as problems. **"That may be somewhat difficult on our side today"** probably means "no, not today" or "there's a real problem": a polite refusal.

◆ EXERCISE 2 – READ THE SOFT SIGNAL (MODELS)

Line	It might mean	A good response
1 "That may be somewhat difficult for us."	probably no, or a serious problem	"I sense this may be difficult — shall we look at another option?"
2 "We'll need to discuss it internally."	not ready to decide; the group decides together	"Of course — please take the time you need. Would it help if I put this in writing?"
3 "Interesting idea. We'll think about it."	maybe polite but not keen	"Please be candid — would a different approach suit you better?"
4 "Hmm... Friday is a little tight."	Friday probably doesn't work	"Would the following Wednesday work better?" / "Whenever works for your team is fine with us."
5 A long silence after the price	concern about the price, or they're thinking	"I want to make sure this works for both sides. What are your thoughts?"

Accept any meaning that treats the line as a possible signal, not a certain one. The key habit is to **check gently** rather than assume. Don't accept responses that push ("So is that a yes?") or ignore the signal.

◆ EXERCISE 3 – FIX THE OPENER AND THE EMAIL (MODELS)

- 1 "Good morning, everyone, and thank you for making the time. It's a real pleasure to meet your team. Before we turn to the details, I'd love to hear how things are going on your side. And please, there's no need to decide anything today: we'll follow up in writing so your team has time to consider it together."
- 2 *Subject: Pricing proposal — for your team's review*
"Dear Ms. Quinn, Thank you again for your time on Tuesday. As promised, I'm attaching our pricing proposal. Please take the time your team needs to review it. Would it be possible to have your thoughts by the end of next week? If another date suits you better, please let me know. Kind regards, Sam Ortiz"

Check for: title + surname, a warm opening, no pressure words (*need, today, EOD*), an invitation to reply, a polite close. **Not yet:** a version that is formal but still demands a same-day answer.

◆ EXERCISE 4 – WHICH SKILL DO YOU NEED?

1	2	3	4	5	6
d	e	b	a	f	c

Other reasonable links are fine if the learner can justify them (e.g. 1 = meetings, if the flaw is raised in a meeting). The point is choosing the right move for the moment.

◆ EXERCISE 5 – ORDER THE FOLLOW-UP EMAIL

d (1) → b (2) → g (3) → f (4) → c (5) → a (6) → e (7)

So: a = 6, b = 2, c = 5, d = 1, e = 7, f = 4, g = 3. Point out the structure: subject line with purpose → greeting → warm thanks → signpost ("To confirm what we discussed") → bullet-point decisions → an invitation to correct + a no-pressure next step → sign-off.

◆ DIALOGUE – THE NEGOTIATION

Acknowledgment: "I completely understand that budget is important, and I want to make this work for both of us." ·

Conditional trade: "if your team can commit to a two-year agreement, we could offer a 10% reduction and hold that rate." ·

Question inviting a reply: "Would that be a helpful direction to explore?" · Confirm in writing: "I'll put the proposal in writing so your team has everything to consider."

◆ SPEAKING – THE CLIENT SCENARIO AND THE CAPSTONE PLANNER

Scenario: no fixed script. Round 1 succeeds if the chair welcomes, makes brief small talk, proposes a light agenda and invites the client to begin. Round 2 needs at least one feature → benefit link and a call to action that respects consensus ("we can share a draft plan by Friday for your team to review"). Round 3 needs an acknowledgment, a conditional offer within the limit (10%, not 15%), space to decide, and a written follow-up. **Capstone planner (model, from Script 4.3-B, expanded to 5 minutes):** topic: a self-service order-tracking page · audience: the Clearwater leadership team · opening: greet, topic, hook ("Six out of every ten calls ask the same question"), what's in it for them, a three-part outline · problem: waits up from 4 to 11 minutes · solution: a tracking page + FAQ in six weeks · benefits: shorter waits, happier customers, agents free for complex calls ("...which means that...") · evidence: IT has built similar pages; the share of tracking calls (60%) · close: "So, to sum up... What I'm asking you to approve today is \$6,000, so IT can start on Monday." · objections: *adoption* ("What if customers don't use it?" → agents mention it on every call; weekly figures for a month) and *cost* ("Why pay now?" → a one-off \$6,000 against long waits every day). Check against the Capstone Pitch Brief checklist in [assessment/final-assessment.html](#): signposts between every part, a specific call to action, two objections prepared.

◆ SELF-CHECK

Q1

First call with a formal, consensus-driven, relationship-first team: which approach fits best?

A) First names, no small talk, a decision by the end of the call.

B) Open warmly and formally, make some small talk, and offer a written summary so their team can decide together.

C) Keep it casual with plenty of idioms.

Why: B starts formal, builds the relationship and gives time for a group decision, confirmed in writing. A clashes with all three preferences; C's idioms confuse and sound too casual.

Q2

A client asks for a bigger discount than you can offer.

A) Simply refuse and repeat the original price.

B) Immediately agree to the full discount.

C) Acknowledge the concern, then offer a conditional trade.

Why: C protects both the relationship and the deal: the client gets something in return for giving something. A can end the conversation; B gives away value for nothing.

Q3 · new

"That may be somewhat difficult for us." What does it most likely mean?

A) Yes, definitely.

B) Probably "no," or there's a real problem: ask gently.

C) They didn't understand you.

Why: in many workplaces, especially more indirect ones, this is a polite way to refuse or to flag a serious problem. The safe move is to check gently and offer an alternative.

Q4 · new

You're not sure what someone's communication norms are.

A) Use your own norms: they're the same everywhere.

B) Start more formal, observe and mirror, and ask when you're unsure.

C) Use lots of idioms to sound friendly.

Why: B combines three golden rules. A is the classic cross-cultural mistake (assuming your norm is universal); C makes you harder to understand.

ERRORS YOU WILL MEET MOST (4.3)

"I am agree / We are agree with this condition" · "discuss about the price" · "If you will commit to two years, we will can..." (✓ *If you commit / can commit..., we could...*) · first names with a new senior contact · over-direct requests ("I want you send the contract," "Give me discount") · idioms (*touch base, circle back, ballpark*) · pushing for a yes after a soft signal · national generalizations in discussion ("They are always...") · capstones with no call to action or no number · reading a full script aloud. For range, praise *There's no need to decide today · Would it help if I put this in writing? · I sense this may be difficult · If you can..., we could....*

FINAL ASSESSMENT PAGE (C15–C16)

◆ GUIDANCE FOR THE WORKBOOK PAGE

- ◆ **Before Class 16 checklist.** Check it at the end of C15 (the close stage) or at the start of C16: learners without a call to action or an interview slot need a quick word before the pitches start.
- ◆ **Performance profile.** Learners fill it in **after** you return results privately (within a week of C16), copying the four criterion scores for Writing and Speaking at Class 1, Class 8 and the Final Assessment from their score sheets. It mirrors [performance-tracker.html](#). If a learner missed a task, the row stays blank; never estimate a score for a missing task. If there was no scored interview, the Speaking score comes from the negotiation and the pitch (noted on the score sheet). Remind learners to read the profile **by criterion across time**, not as one rising line.
- ◆ **Action plan.** A good plan names one real goal, two habits that are specific and frequent ("I'll put the ask in the first line of every email," "I'll tell one STAR story a week and record it"), a real situation in the next month and a review date. Push back gently on vague plans ("practice more English") with "When? With whom? How will you know?"
- ◆ **Final Assessment answers.** Model answers for the C15 writing, the shape of a good deal for both negotiation scenarios and the scoring guidance for pitches and interviews are in [assessment/assessment-key.html](#) and the teacher pages of [assessment/final-assessment.html](#).